

KEVIN ZELMAN

IT & Operations Leader · Infrastructure · Security · Enterprise Transformation

New York Metro Area • kzelman97@gmail.com • (908) 247-2592 • linkedin.com/in/kevin-zelman • kevinzelman.github.io

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

IT and operations leader with nearly a decade of progressive responsibility across higher education, nonprofit, and real estate — most recently running a college-wide technology transformation end-to-end: authored the modernization strategy adopted by the President's Cabinet, then delivered it — retiring 7+ legacy platforms, consolidating a fragmented stack onto Microsoft 365, closing a directory-wide security gap, and cutting redundant vendor spend — while recruiting and coordinating the team that runs it. Operates at director scope today: owns the vendor portfolio and licensing decisions, leads incident command and the institution's SOC relationship, handles confidential personnel matters with HR and Legal, and partners directly with the CIO and the President's Office. Rare combination of executive judgment and deep hands-on credibility (Microsoft Entra ID, Cisco, Azure/VMware, PowerShell + Graph automation): sets the strategy, and can execute any layer of it personally.

LEADERSHIP HIGHLIGHTS

- **Set strategy adopted at the top** — authored the “Strategic Roadmap for System Retirement and Replacement” presented to the President's Cabinet, then executed it: 7+ legacy platforms (identity, telephony, portal, AV, email security, admin tooling, backup) retired in 14 months with no added headcount.
- **Delivered enterprise programs on schedule** — enterprise SSO migration across ~18,000 identities and 74 applications; a 200-line telephony cutover to Microsoft Teams Phone (E911-compliant, on schedule); server-estate migration to Azure VMware Solution; endpoint-protection replacement college-wide.
- **Owned cost and vendor stewardship** — manage a multi-vendor portfolio (MSP/MDR, Cisco, Microsoft licensing, telecom, print, emergency notification); cancelled a redundant ~\$29K identity contract (~\$10K/yr saving), declined non-essential renewals, right-sized licensing, and built automated license reclamation into offboarding.
- **Accountable for risk and compliance** — drove the external vulnerability scan to 0 Critical / 0 High / 0 Medium; closed a 10,873-account MFA gap; led incident response as the institution's MDR/SOC liaison; performed a HIPAA/HITECH assessment and documented PCI compensating controls.
- **Built and led the team** — initiated the recruiting that backfilled two departed technicians, coordinate the IT support team's scheduling and field operations, and execute confidential employee separations directly with HR, General Counsel, and Security.
- **Trusted at the executive level** — recurring operations-improvement working sessions with the President's Office; prepares and delivers CIO decision briefings; led a President-sponsored digital-campus program through 16 department handoffs.
- **Institutionalized operational excellence** — replaced manual processes with self-maintaining automation (a 118-group dynamic-audience engine sourced from the student-information system, directory-audit reporting, daily operations digests): “onboarding and offboarding happen by data, not by ticket.”
- **A repeatable modernization playbook** — migrated a 300-person nonprofit to Azure AD + SSO (2019–2023), led a datacenter migration cutting equipment footprint 66% for a NYC real-estate firm (2023–2025), then ran the same plays at 18,000-identity, campus-wide scale. Three organizations, one pattern: modernize, consolidate, automate.

EXPERIENCE

St. Francis College — Brooklyn, NY

Network Manager, IT (2026–Present) · promoted from IT Consultant within 9 months (2025–2026)

Scope: de-facto infrastructure & operations lead for a ~3,800-member NYC college — ~18,000-account directory, campus network and cloud estate, security program, telephony, vendor portfolio, and IT support team.

Strategy, Governance & Executive Partnership

- Authored the executive modernization roadmap adopted by the President's Cabinet and delivered the resulting multi-year consolidation program; prepare CIO decision briefings (decision matrices, risk framing, anticipated-questions prep) and serve as IT's technical voice to leadership.
- Partner with the President's Office in recurring working sessions to streamline college operations; led the President-sponsored SharePoint digital-campus program (26 sites, 30+ pages) from strategy through 16 department handoffs to college-wide launch (July 2026), replacing a paid vendor platform at no added cost; produced executive service-desk reporting for Middle States (MSCHE) accreditation.

Transformation & Program Delivery

- Led the enterprise identity migration from OneLogin and on-premises Active Directory to Microsoft Entra ID + Microsoft 365 SSO (~18,000 identities, 74 federated applications) — planned the phased program, executed the cutover over the holiday break as the sole institutional engineer, and resolved a Severity-A admin lockout with zero extended downtime.
- Directed the SFC side of the RingCentral → Microsoft Teams Phone migration with an implementation partner — 199 numbers ported, E911-compliant, delivered on schedule with room-by-room go-live verification — and the server-estate migration to Azure VMware Solution with modernized, immutable cloud backup/DR.

Security, Risk & Compliance

- Primary institutional liaison to a managed-detection-and-response (MDR) SOC with a standing weekly security review; lead incident response end-to-end on account compromise, phishing/BEC, and threat-actor events — including coordinating a live threat-actor investigation across a third-party-managed SIS stack — frequently authoring the root-cause analysis.
- Commanded the diagnosis of a campus-wide wireless outage: triangulated evidence across the NAC, directory, and wireless controller to root-cause an 802.1X authentication storm, then authored the incident report, remediation runbook, and recovery instructions delivered to IT leadership within 48 hours.
- Authored a six-source perimeter firewall audit with a CIO-level remediation roadmap and drove the external vulnerability scan to 0 Critical / 0 High / 0 Medium; ran the identity-hygiene program that surfaced and remediated a directory-wide MFA gap (10,873 accounts surfaced; 4,200+ remediated by automation).
- Migrated endpoint protection to Microsoft Defender with an Intune hardening baseline; performed a HIPAA/HITECH compliance assessment and documented PCI compensating controls for the legacy student-information stack.

Operations, Service & Business Continuity

- Operate the campus technology estate day-to-day — Cisco access/wireless network, dual-ISP edge, Microsoft 365 tenant — resolving outages (public-website, wireless-auth, core-network incidents) and driving vendor escalations to closure.
- Core member of the emergency mass-notification team; front-line responder in a production lockout of the emergency-alert platform, restoring administrative access with the vendor. Escalation lead for the service desk; stood up the help-desk ticketing system and authored end-user self-service documentation.

People, Vendors & Budget

- Initiated the recruiting effort that backfilled two technician departures; coordinate team scheduling, coverage, and field-technician direction during campus-wide rollouts; execute confidential offboardings with HR, General Counsel, and Security.
- Day-to-day commercial and technical owner for the vendor portfolio; drove identity-vendor consolidation onto existing Microsoft licensing (cancelled ~\$29K redundant contract, ~\$10K/yr saving), declined redundant renewals, and right-sized purchases across telephony, diagramming, and print.

Independent IT Consultant — Self-Employed, New York, NY

(2024–2025)

- Ran an independent consulting practice for NYC small businesses: Microsoft 365 / SharePoint implementations for remote collaboration, asset-management assessments, and cabling / hardware-provisioning projects — client-facing scoping, delivery, and support end-to-end. Engagement quality led directly to the St. Francis College consultancy and subsequent management role.

Ogden CAP Properties — New York, NY

Help Desk Manager / Network Administrator (2023–2024)

- Led a comprehensive datacenter migration achieving a 66% reduction in equipment footprint — planning, logistics, and hands-on execution — and remediated findings from failed IT audits while documenting the infrastructure estate across six NYC properties (~500 users).
- Managed relationships with managed-service providers and third-party vendors; served as interim team lead, and partnered directly with senior management to align IT operations with organizational goals.
- Operated a Fortinet / Cisco ASA, Meraki (networks + iPhone MDM), Okta MFA, and Azure environment with PDQ-automated patching; rebuilt the help desk's reference library into a structured knowledge base and served in the 24/7 on-call rotation.

Union for Reform Judaism (URJ) — New York, NY

Help Desk Manager / System Administrator (2019–2023)

- Led the transition of 300+ staff to remote work during the COVID-19 pandemic — prepped and distributed ~200 laptops, coordinated logistics with HR and executives, and kept a 15+ site organization (US, Canada, Israel) operating through its defining business-continuity event.
- Played a key role migrating the organization to Azure AD and Azure SSO as a Microsoft 365 Global Admin — the identity playbook later executed at 18,000-identity scale at St. Francis College.
- Routinely acted for the IT Director in their absence — organizational communications, project management, and executive-facing representation — and provided direct IT support to the organization's President; ran CITO-approved phishing-simulation campaigns (KnowBe4) and trained 350+ users on MFA via org-wide webinars.
- Automated operations with PowerApps (project-submission app with director approvals), Power Automate, and PowerShell; built the knowledge base and onboarding documentation that measurably reduced daily tickets.

Earlier roles: Pace University ITS — Client Support Officer (2018–2019): PowerShell automation for Active Directory data integration and OS deployment. · MicroCare, Inc. — Field Technician (2017–2018): designed and deployed network architectures and security systems for 8+ NYC businesses.

EDUCATION

Pace University, Seidenberg School of Computer Science — New York, NY

B.S. Information Technology, Minor in Information Assurance in Criminal Justice (2021) · Vice President, Cybersecurity Club · Seidenberg Peer Mentor

SECURITY COMPETITIONS & COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

- **National Cyber League — Gold Bracket (top 15% nationally), three consecutive seasons (2019–2020)** — peaked at the 93rd national percentile (Preseason, Spring 2020: #389 of 5,379) and ranked #80 of 4,149 nationally (top 2%) in Cryptography (Fall 2019). Externally verifiable via Cyber Skyline scouting reports.
- **Cybersecurity Team Coach, Pace University (Fall 2021, volunteer)** — returned post-graduation to coach the NCL competition team: training plans with faculty, regular practice sessions, and individual mentorship across cryptography, network traffic analysis, and web application security.
- **Founded and ran a cybersecurity mentoring community** — authored a career-entry guide ("Guide to CyberSec Success"), curated a learning-resource library, and mentored aspiring security professionals through a Discord community with feedback surveys.
- **Peer Mentor, Seidenberg School (2019–2020)** — mentored incoming students and administered penetration tests with Pace faculty; supported mentee projects in data science and SANS cybersecurity coursework.

TECHNICAL FOUNDATION

Leadership backed by current, hands-on depth — sets strategy and can personally execute any layer of it:

Identity & Security: Microsoft Entra ID, M365 SSO/SAML, MFA/SSPR, Conditional Access, Microsoft Defender, MDR/SOC operations, Cisco Firepower, Tenable Nessus, incident response, vulnerability management

Network & Cloud: Cisco ISE, Catalyst 9800 WLC, SD-Access, BGP/dual-ISP, Azure VMware Solution, VMware/vSphere, Cloudflare DNS

Platforms & Automation: Microsoft 365 administration, Teams Phone, SharePoint, Exchange, Intune, PowerShell, Microsoft Graph, self-maintaining automation

CERTIFICATIONS

ManageEngine ADManager Plus — Associate (MECPA), 2025 · Continuant — Microsoft Teams for Calling (Basics & Advanced), 2025